

Old Baseball Deals Prove There's No Bored Of Trade

Although you couldn't prove it by Charley Finley, some of the best deals ARE the ones a ball club doesn't make. For instance, San Diego's turning down offers a year ago for a large-sized lefthanded loser whose fast ball wouldn't blacken your eye.

Sure, you've heard the name, Randy Jones, who went from 8-24 in 1974 to 26-12 last year and promises now to reach 25 victories or more.

"We had some interesting offers for Randy, but, unfortunately, rejected them all," said Peter Bavasi, the new Toronto general manager who was helping his papa, Buzzy, spend Ray Kroc's McDonald hamburger money to turn San Diego from an oasis for visiting ball clubs into one for weather-conscious tourists and residents.

The one about the Jones boy who wasn't traded is included in a new book about many ball players who were dealt or—listening, Commissioner Bowie Kuhn?—sold in the first century of big league baseball.

Called "Trade Him!" and subtitled, "100 Years of Baseball's Greatest Deals", the book was published recently by Follett of Chicago, priced at \$8.95. It was edited by Jim Enright, retired

Chicago baseball writer and basketball referee who persuaded an ink-stained wretch in each major league city to recite and evaluate each club's transactions.

In at least one instance, a reporter recited a little poetry (?), too, as the New York News's Red Foley resurrected a bit of rhyme from the New York Baseball Writers' dinner early in 1928 after the Giants had dealt slugging second baseman Rogers Hornsby to the Boston Braves for catcher Shanty Hogan and center fielder Jimmy Welsh, installing rookie Andy Cohen as The Rajah's successor.

Wailed New York writers that winter in prophetic song parody:

"All your Welshes, Cohens and Hogans Won't begin to fill the brogans That Rogers Hornsby wore so well at second base."

As one who wrote the St. Louis chapter, the longest and windiest in the book, I'm not about to review it. Joe Pollack, the busy man of many writing facets, all of them turned on, might get around to evaluating "Trade Him!"

But at a time when the book properly should be called, "Trade or Sell Him—If He'll Go and If the Commissioner

bob broeg
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Doesn't Say Nay," I'd like to pass along a few tidbits that tickled me.

In the book's introduction, for instance, Joe Garagiola, quipping that he didn't mind being dealt because, after all, one bullpen looked like another to him, remembered the debating experience of a Pittsburgh-to-Chicago move.

When Garagiola joined the Cubs in New York, general manager Wid Matthews greeted him, "Hiya, Joe. Wait until you see (Harry) Chiti."

That ego-dashing greeting reminded a guy of another one about Chiti, a big catcher who once reminded someone of Chicago of Gabby Hartnett because Harry also had two arms and two legs. In the New York Mets' first year of existence, general manager George Weiss announced that the Mets had obtained Chiti from Cleveland "for a player to be named later."

Several disappointing days later, as the Long Island Press's Jack Lang related, the Mets named the player they were giving up for Chiti. Yeah, you guessed it. They gave up Chiti for Chiti.

Pretty good cracks here and there in the book, all right, as, for example, manager Fred Haney's remark when the California Angels dealt playboy Bo Belinsky to Philadelphia.

"That's the first time," snickered Haney, "that overnight a stud became a Philly."

And when Al (The Bull) Ferrara said a tearful, champagne-flavored afirewell when traded by the Padres to Cincinnati, he told the San Diego Union's Phil Collier:

"Do you realize that the next time I see you, I'll be trying to beat the Padres?"

"Cripes," Collier cracked, "you've been doing that for years, Bull."

The little things so often become big in a baseball deal.

At the 1946 World Series between the Cardinals and Red Sox at Boston's Fenway Park, Bill Vecek of Cleveland offered the Yankees' Larry MacPhail pitcher Allie Reynolds for second baseman Joe Gordon and infielder Ed Bockman. Or, if MacPhail preferred, Vecek said he'd make it pitcher Red Embree for Gordon even up, figuring the New York cub president would take the second deal.

An instant before the handshake that would have made the deal Vecek wanted, MacPhail saw Yankee outfielder Joe DiMaggio in the stands and said, "Wait a minute. I'd like to check it out with DiMag."

Joe Dee told MacPhail he had rocks in his head if he didn't take Reynolds. Sure, Gordon helped Cleveland to a pennant in 1948, but The Chief pitched the Yankees to several championships.

There were some beaux over the years, deals that were made or not made. Like the time Cleveland haughtily turned down a trade with Detroit for veteran outfielder Elmer Flick because they thought that the young Tiger outfielder offered in return was a big unmanageable. Uh-huh, Ty Cobb.

The Philadelphia Athletics once bought controlling interest in the Portland Pacific Coast League club so that Connie Mack could get his bony hands on a catcher named Gordon Stanley (Mickey) Cochrane. And Cochrane, a

fiery leader behind the plate at Philly, became player-manager at Detroit only because Babe Ruth, bound for Hawaii, told the Tigers' Frank Navin to cool it when Navin had permission with the Yankees after the 1933 season to deal with the old Babe as player-manager.

While Ruth was walking the beach at Waikiki, Detroit sports editor H. G. Salsinger and automobile Walter O. Briggs, offering to put up the money, convinced Navin that Detroit needed an in-the-prime catcher more than an over-the-hill outfielder.

So Briggs put up the \$100,000 to land Cochrane, who immediately spurred the Tigers to two pennants, including a 1935 world championship over the Chicago Cubs.

And speaking of the Cubs, who have been unspeakable most of the time since 1945, did you know that the No. 1 trivia question, "Who played third base in the infield with Tinker, Evers and Chance?" almost had a different answer?

Trying to beat out Pittsburgh and New York, Chicago gave up lefthanded pitcher Jake Weimer to Cincinnati for third baseman Harry Steinfield before the 1906 season. The Cubs responded with a record 116 victories.

And there was nothing trivial to the contribution of St. Louisan Steinfield, the forgotten man of that famous Chicago infield. Harry hit higher in '06 than Joe Tinkers or Johnny Evers or Frank Chance with is .327 average.

As Casey Stengel would say, "You could look it up"—in the book about the best and worst of 100 years of baseball trades.

sports shorts

Track And Field

Two 1976 world best were recorded in the World Games in Helsinki, Finland, a 27 minute, 42.85 second clocking in the 10,000-meter run by Lasse Viren of Finland and a 306 feet, 11 inches javelin throw by Seppo Hovinen of Finland.

Russia's Valeri Borzov, winner of both the 100-meter dash and 200-

Basketball

Brazil, Czechoslovakia and Mexico, all with 2-0 records, were tied for first place after two days of play in the Olympic Games men's basketball qualifying meet in Hamilton, Ont. The top three teams in the 13-nation meet advance to the Olympic Games, scheduled to open July 17 in Montreal.

Rangers Gain On Kansas City

Compiled From News Services

The Texas Rangers did their best to hand the Kansas City Royals a victory last night, but the Royals, playing the role of perfect guests, refused to take it. The Rangers gave up four unearned runs, allowed two stolen bases, were out 10-7 and made more than one mental error, a category not listed in the box score. But they still won 7-5 and thus cut their deficit to

Steinmetz Wins, Oberheide Loses

DALLAS, Tex., June 24—Kim Steinmetz of St. Louis defeated Brenda Hook of Dallas, 6-1, 7-6, and Lori Oberheide of St. Louis was eliminated by Carolyn Stoll of Livingston, N.J., 7-5, 5-7, 6-3, here yesterday in third-round matches in the 18-and-under singles division of the Maureen Connolly Brinker girls tennis

Amateur Baseball

MISSOURI ILLINOIS COLLEGIATE LEAGUE
University of Missouri-St. Louis 5,
Washington U. 1
McKendree 2, St. Louis U. 1